

» AFTER

The number of US ground troops in Vietnam continued to rise until 1969, as did the number of US casualties.

MORE TROOPS

General Westmoreland asked for **more US troops** to be sent to Vietnam. Troop numbers peaked at 543,000 in the spring of 1969. Despite US, South Vietnamese, and Australian action in 1965, 1966, and 1967, the enemy's back was far from broken, and the 1968 **Tet Offensive** brought the heaviest fighting of the war for the United States. At the same time, US casualties—some 14,000 killed and almost twice that number wounded in 1968—fueled **opposition to the war at home**.